

EMAIL WARMUP PLAN

Domain Age	15 days (new – requires warmup)
Issue Observed	Emails going to spam for some recipients
Root Cause	Low sender reputation on new domain/mailbox
Recommended Action	Structured email warmup over 4–6 weeks
Plan Duration	6 Weeks
Prepared For	Internal IT / Email Admin Team

1. Email Warmup

Email warmup is the process of gradually increasing the volume of emails sent from a new email address or domain. Internet Service Providers (ISPs) and spam filters like Gmail, Outlook, and Yahoo use sender reputation to decide whether your emails land in the inbox or spam folder.

A new email has no history of sending legitimate emails, which makes spam filters suspicious of it.

2. Checklist

Complete these technical steps before beginning the warmup:

- SPF Record: Add a TXT record to your DNS confirming which servers can send mail from your domain.
- DKIM Record: Enable DomainKeys Identified Mail to digitally sign outgoing emails.
- DMARC Record: Set a policy to handle emails that fail SPF/DKIM checks.
- Custom Tracking Domain: Use a branded tracking domain, not a shared one.
- Professional Email Signature: Include name, designation, company, and contact.
- Unsubscribe Link: Include in any bulk/marketing emails (required by law in many countries).

4. 6-Week Warmup Schedule

Gradually increase email volume each week. Start very low and build trust with ISPs.

Week	Days Active	Emails / Day	Total Emails	Focus & Activity
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1	5 days	5–10	25–50	Send to known contacts only (colleagues, personal contacts who will open & reply)
2	5 days	10–20	50–100	Expand to team members, internal stakeholders; ask recipients to reply or move from spam
3	5 days	20–40	100–200	Add trusted business contacts; monitor open rates; avoid cold outreach
4	5 days	40–75	200–375	Begin cautious outreach to warm leads; maintain reply engagement
5	5 days	75–150	375–750	Introduce semi-cold emails; keep bounce rate below 2%
6	5 days	150–300	750–1500	Normal operations; fully warmed domain ready for campaigns

5. Best Practices During Warmup

Content & Engagement

- Send relevant, personalised emails — generic or promotional emails get marked as spam.
- Ask recipients to reply or add your email to their contacts.
- Avoid spam trigger words: 'Free', 'Guaranteed', 'Act Now', 'Click Here', 'Winner', etc.
- Keep email subject lines clear and professional.

Technical & Volume

- Send emails gradually throughout the day do not blast all at once.
- Maintain a consistent daily sending schedule.
- Keep hard bounce rate below 2% and spam complaint rate below 0.1%.
- Remove invalid or bounced email addresses immediately.

Monitoring

- Use Google Postmaster Tools (free) to track your domain reputation with Gmail.
- Use Mail-Tester.com to check your spam score before campaigns.
- Check Microsoft SNDS (Smart Network Data Services) for Outlook reputation.
- Review bounce reports and spam complaints weekly.

6. What to Avoid

- Do NOT send to purchased or scraped email lists during warmup.
- Do NOT use URL shorteners (bit.ly, tinyurl) - they trigger spam filters.
- Do NOT send attachments to people who have not requested them.
- Do NOT ignore bounce notifications or spam complaints.
- Do NOT skip weeks or rush the process - this will hurt reputation significantly.

7. We can also use Automated Warmup Tool

If manual warmup feels too complex, consider using a dedicated email warmup service. These tools automate the process by simulating human like email engagement:

- Lemwarm (by Lemlist) : popular and beginner-friendly
- Warmbox.ai : supports multiple email providers
- Mailreach.co : strong deliverability analytics
- Instantly.ai : good for teams and agencies

Note: Most tools have a monthly subscription fee but can significantly speed up the warmup process safely.